

HEIRS OF THE FORGOTTEN DALE – HEXCRAWL

RULES GUIDE



EX SCALE: 1 HEX = 3 MILES (1 LEAGUE)

This guide covers travel, daily structure, mapping, and basic visibility. Encounters and specific map features will be handled separately.

1. DAILY SCHEDULE

Each day is divided into four phases. This structure gives rhythm to travel while allowing meaningful downtime and activities.

Phase	Duration	Focus	Movement	Best Used	
				For	Downtime
Morning	~4 hours	Travel or explore + activities	1–2 hexes	Tool use, crafting, light mapping	Light to Moderate
Midday	~2–3 hours	Meal + short rest + exploration	0–1 hex	Exploration, light tasks	Mandatory (meal + short rest)
Afternoon	~4 hours	Travel or explore	1–2 hexes	Main travel window	Light
Night	—	Camp setup + Long Rest	None	Recovery	Full

Total active time per day: Roughly 10–11 hours.

2. MOVEMENT RATES

Terrain	Hexes per	Miles per	Notes
	Day	Day	
Clear / Plains / Road	4–5	12–15	Fastest normal travel
Hills / Light Forest	3	9	Standard wilderness travel
Dense Forest / Swamp	2	6	Slow going
Mountains	1	3	Very difficult

- **Fast Pace:** +1 hex per day (higher chance of getting lost or missing things)
- **Slow / Cautious Pace:** -1 hex per day (better chance of noticing details)

These numbers are slightly slower than raw 5e calculations to account for navigation, caution, breaks, and the realities of wilderness travel.

3. MAPPING RULES

The party can create usable maps of the hexes they travel through.

How Mapping Works

- **Cost:** The party **moves 1 fewer hex** than normal that day.

- **Time:** Mapping is done by spending extra time in the hex being mapped.
- **Retroactive:** The party can return to a previously visited hex later to map it.

BENEFITS OF A MAPPED HEX

While the party possesses the map of a hex, they gain the following:

- **Never Get Lost:** The party cannot become lost while traveling through mapped hexes.
- **Accurate Navigation:** They can reliably retrace their steps and find specific locations within the mapped area.
- **Detailed Record:** They have a reliable record of terrain and major features.
- **Future Advantage:** If they return to a mapped hex later, they have better knowledge of the area.

Limitation: Only **one hex** can be mapped per day.

4. VISIBILITY

Base Visibility: The party can see **3 hexes** away in normal terrain and clear weather.

MODIFIERS (GM DISCRETION)

- **Hills or high ground:** +1 hex
- **Mountains / Very high ground:** Significantly increased (landmarks especially visible)
- **Light Forest:** -1 hex
- **Dense Forest, Fog, or Heavy Rain:** -2 hexes (can drop to 1 hex)
- **Night:** Reduced to 1 hex (unless using light sources)

Landmarks (large mountains, towers, smoke, etc.) can often be seen from farther away than normal terrain.

5. DOWNTIME & ACTIVITIES

The daily structure naturally includes time for downtime and character activities.

GOOD TIMES FOR ACTIVITIES

- **Morning Phase:** Best window for tool use, crafting, practicing skills, studying, or light mapping.
- **Midday Phase:** Mandatory meal + short rest. Good for light tasks or exploration.
- **Afternoon Phase:** Usually focused on travel.
- **Night Phase:** Long Rest and watches.

Characters have meaningful time each day to work on tools, craft simple items, or pursue personal goals without the entire day feeling like constant marching.

SUMMARY OF A TYPICAL DAY

Example:

- **Morning:** Travel 1 hex + map the new hex.
- **Midday:** Meal + short rest + explore current hex.
- **Afternoon:** Travel 1 more hex.
- **Night:** Set up camp and take a Long Rest.

Total movement: 2 hexes (instead of the usual 3).

These rules are designed to be **light on bookkeeping** while still giving weight to exploration, mapping, and daily rhythm. Encounters, random events, and specific map features will be added in a separate section.